



# **Sample essay: A Memorable Journey through a Historical City**

# Introduction

**(Reader's Hook- *Rhetorical Question*)** Have you ever walked through a city where history whispers from ancient walls?

**(Context)** The unique blend of history, energy, and human warmth defines Lahore as a city. **(Thesis Statement)** Lahore is the cultural heart of Pakistan, showcasing its beautiful old buildings, experiencing the vibrant energy of its busy streets, and embracing the genuine warmth of its friendly people.

**(Transitional Hook)** The city invites visitors to experience its culture through its majestic old structures to the metropolitan sites.

## Body Paragraph 1: Physical Description

Lahore is visually striking because of its rich blend of old architecture and lively urban scenes. The city is home to grand historical buildings made of red brick and marble, with detailed arches, domes, and carved walls that reflect centuries of craftsmanship. Narrow streets open into wide roads filled with colourful shops, food stalls, and glowing signboards. From the majestic forts and mosques to the crowded bazaars, Lahore's physical appearance presents a strong contrast between historical beauty and modern activity. These physical features become more meaningful when viewed within the city's social environment and daily life. **(Transitional Hook)** To understand this further, it is important to consider Lahore's busy surroundings and its constant movement through time.

## Body Paragraph 2: Contextual Description

Situated in the heart of Punjab, Lahore exists within a vibrant cultural and social context that shapes its identity. The city's streets are rarely quiet, as traffic, street vendors, and pedestrians fill the surroundings from morning until late at night. Historic buildings stand alongside modern structures, showing how the past and present coexist. Seasonal festivals, cultural events, and everyday routines create a rhythm that defines life in Lahore. This lively context not only shapes the city's atmosphere but also influences how people feel when they experience it. **(Transitional Hook)**As a result, Lahore affects people emotionally by creating both excitement and a strong sense of belonging.

## **Body Paragraph 3: Emotional Description**

Beyond its appearance and surroundings, Lahore leaves a strong emotional impression on those who experience and visit the city. Visitors often feel welcome in its friendliness and warmth, where people readily smile, offer help, and share stories with strangers. The lively streets evoke excitement and curiosity, while the presence of old buildings inspires pride and nostalgia for the city's rich past. Together, these emotions make Lahore feel less like a crowded urban space and more like a place of connection, comfort, and belonging.

## Conclusion

In conclusion, Lahore can be described as the cultural heart of Pakistan, where history, vibrant energy, and human warmth come together to form a unique identity. Through its historic architecture, lively surroundings, and emotionally engaging atmosphere, the city becomes more than just a physical location. For people beyond Lahore, it represents how urban spaces can preserve tradition while adapting to modern life. As a result, Lahore stands as a reminder that cities are not built only of bricks and roads, but also of shared memories, emotions, and human connections.

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|----|----|
| Introduction                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                |    |    |
| Reader's hook                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 2                                              | 9  |    |
| Anecdote, question, interesting fact                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                |    |    |
| Setting /Background (Lead-in)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 2                                              |    |    |
| Provides the context/setting to the description:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                |    |    |
| Three-Point Thesis Statement                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 5                                              |    |    |
| Thesis statement sentence is clear with three supporting ideas                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                |    |    |
| Organization (3 Body Paragraph)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                |    |    |
| Each paragraph has a topic sentence<br>provides a controlling idea (transitional hooks- 2 each thesis points)<br>provides supporting details (2 major& minor)<br>Specific examples are given. Includes vivid sensory details and descriptions Examples are concrete with sensory details<br>appear in order (thesis) | (.5+.5+.5)<br>1.5<br>(.75 each<br>6)4.5<br>2+1 | 11 |    |
| Coherence                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                |    |    |
| Vocabulary/word choice-Uses imagery, figurative language and precise language                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 2                                              |    |    |
| Transitions are used to create a smooth flow linking sentences and paragraphs and guide the reader to "see" the subject of the essay.                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                |    |    |
| Conclusion                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                |    |    |
| Thesis is restated- key points summarized-Includes a concluding remark/statement                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 2+1=3                                          | 3  |    |
| Mechanics                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                |    |    |
| spelling, punctuation, Verb tenses correct Subject/verb agreement Contractions and idioms used when appropriate                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 2                                              | 2  |    |
| Total marks                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                |    | 25 |